ALI
FELSKI
DESIGN

Design, UX, Research, Education & Design Direction

Case Studies

Case Study #1

BILL / Divvy Integration

Project

Integration of two discreet products, and pushing designers toward better usability through improved UX and visual design.

My Deliverables / Role

Director of Design (Platform team) - in charge of design systems, cross-company collaboration, design vision, and communication strategies.

Platform Team Goals

In order for BILL to reach its company goals, the scalability, design and usability of our products hinged on the Platform team and their goals laid out below.

Integrated Product Experience

Accelerate Build Time and Innovation

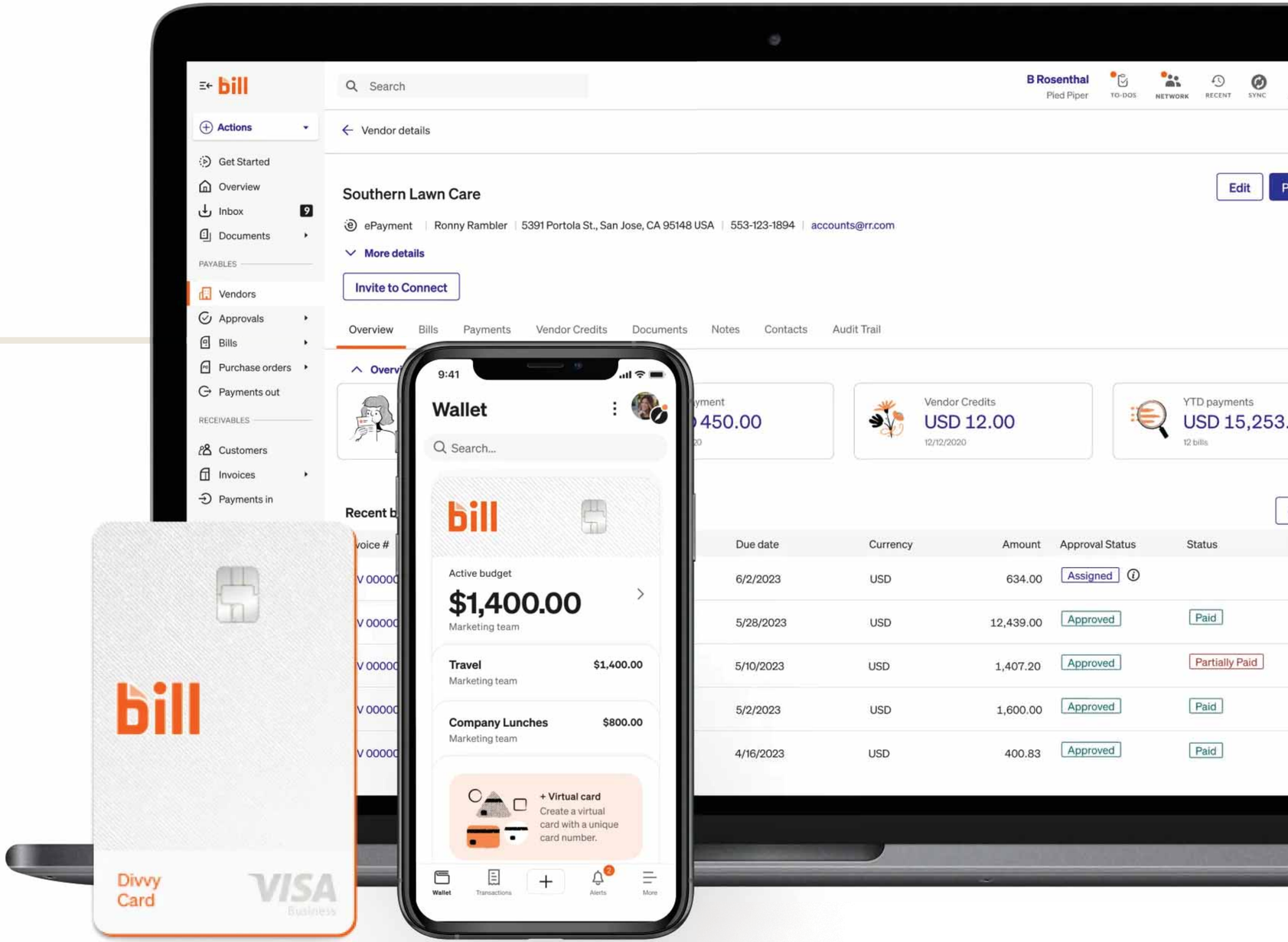
A Scalable Foundation

Our BHAG: To Improve Speed by 10x

Result

Through trust building, processes and good comms off the bat, I was able to lead my team and others to a well designed, consistent and more usable product.

And although this work didn't improve speed by 10x, it did double it.



Results by Numbers

~70% Acceptance of Design System

Constant and consistent comms plus building partnerships paid off in our design systems adoption.

Unified Brand

Between consistent branding and a more modern harmonious system, this led to better brand recognition and happier customers.

Upleveling Designers and Their Work

Although this piece is hard to measure, the work we did on the Platform team became the measuring stick for what others implemented.

Team Harmony Increased by 28%

Giving my employees a reliable ear, expectations / processes and enabling them and their work, made my 360 review scores climb.

The Details

Challenges / Where We Started

Lacking Design System

BILL had an inadequate design system with a low adoption rate of 35-40%.

People Conflict

BILL was rife with people conflict which siloed most teams and created desperate designs.

Lack of Processes / Expectations

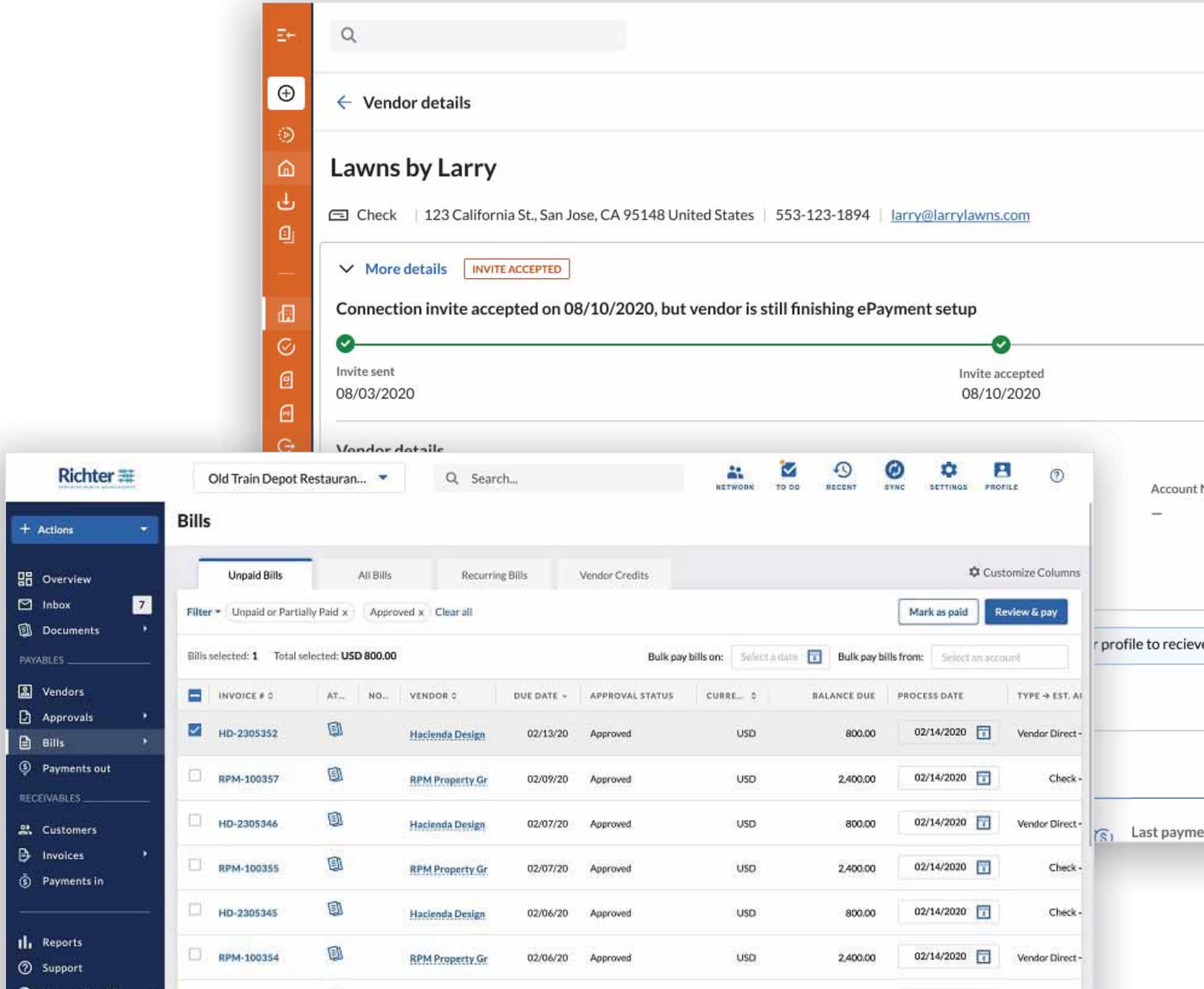
Even though BILL was an established company, their tenure, unfortunately, did not translate to having thought out design practices or set processes.

Lack of Established Leadership

Many of the leaders for this new initiative were new to BILL employees, including myself.

Dated Design

The BILL system as a whole was incredibly old and hard to update from the lack of a design system.



My Process Oriented Setup

Because this was such a large and encompassing initiative, there were a lot of initial hurdles to get everyone on board. And with the lack of established processes and/or expectations, I also needed to built those pieces for my team. Here are the steps I initially took to set a good foundation for this initiative.

Process / Expectation Setting

Establishing Relationships

Evaluating People

Solid Research Strategy Throughout

Comms Strategy

Increase Adoption of Design System

My Design Approach

Rebrand Across Platforms / Consistency

Once our new branding was finalized, I rolled out updates to BILL and Divvy's design systems so that they both had a consistent visual language.

Redesign Components

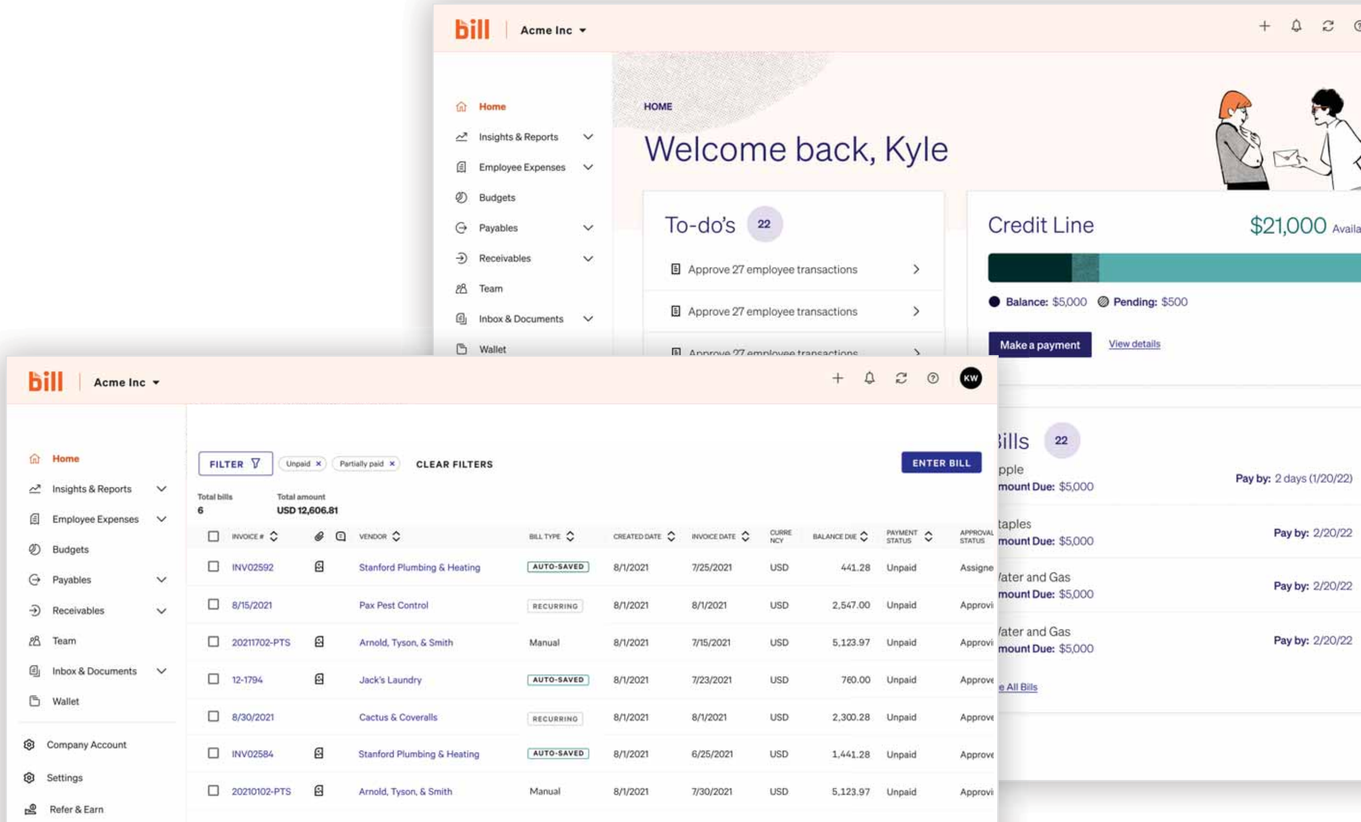
Working from our design vision and also from the our newly defined definition of quality, I led my Design Systems manager, as well as Principle Designers to improve the overall look and feel of our systems' components.

Design Vision

Working from the brand guidelines I worked with a team of senior ranking designers, to establish how those guidelines / designs would translate to our product. Setting a vision / inspiration for designers to work from.

System for Contributions

Not having enough resources on the Design System team and also wanting designers to feel empowered to design in our system, I again worked with the Design Systems manager and teams across the organization to create a system for contributions.



Case Study #2

Mariana Tek
Improving Key Flows

Project

Keeping customers in their class booking flow to decrease customer drop rates.

My Deliverables / Role

Director of Design - In charge of brand direction (with the exception of the logo), the design team / design within the products as well as designing the website experience.

Business Goals

Mariana Tek had been around for 5 years before I joined but in that time had retained only a handful of clients.

Rapidly Increase Customer Acquisition

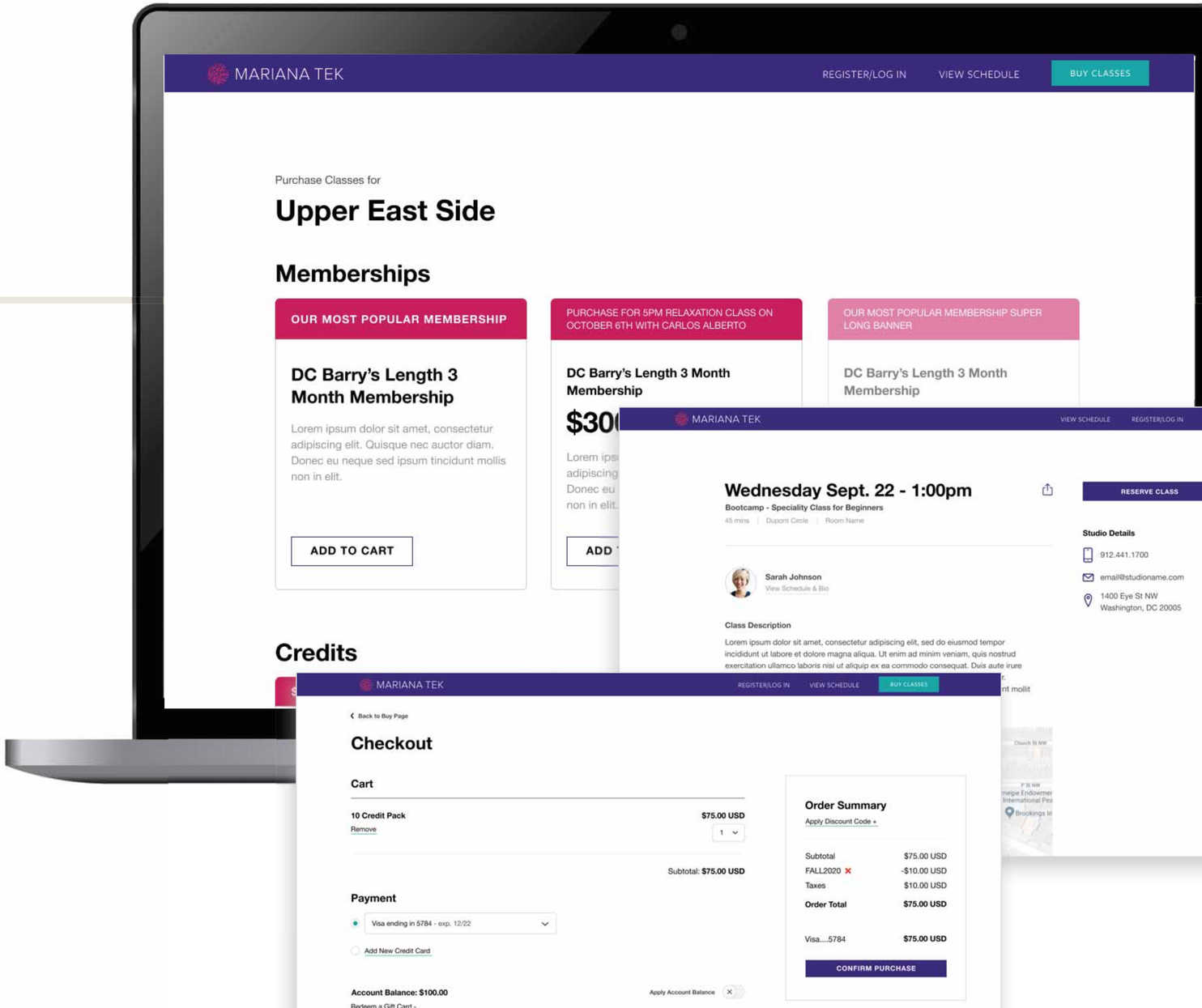
Improve UX and Design

Fewer support tickets, customer questions and complaints.

Increase Revenue and Runway

Result

Though building out a full brand, data gathering to discover customer drop off points, collaboration, a comms strategy, continued research and leveraging great UX patterns, I built a system with the Mariana team that not only worked for our customers but made them successful.



Results by Numbers

Increased and Retained Customers by 20x

Having a product that was more usable and visually appealing, drew in and retained many more customers.

Doubled Development Speed

Implementing a full design system alongside rebuilding critical infrastructure pieces made developing new areas even easier.

Consistent Products Across Platforms

By building a brand, managing and pushing my design team to a new vision we created a focused and recognizable brand across many applications.

Company Purchased

Once our product changes were completed, Mariana's product started taking off. And a year after I started, they were purchased.

Reduction in Customer Drop-off by 30%

Customers stayed in the flow and completed their transactions.

The Details

Challenges / Where We Started

Poor UX & Design

On many key pages, customers were taken out of their flow leading them away from fulling their main purpose. For example:

Customers were not able to see available classes until logging in.

When a class package needed to be purchased, the customer was pushed back to the beginning of the class booking process.

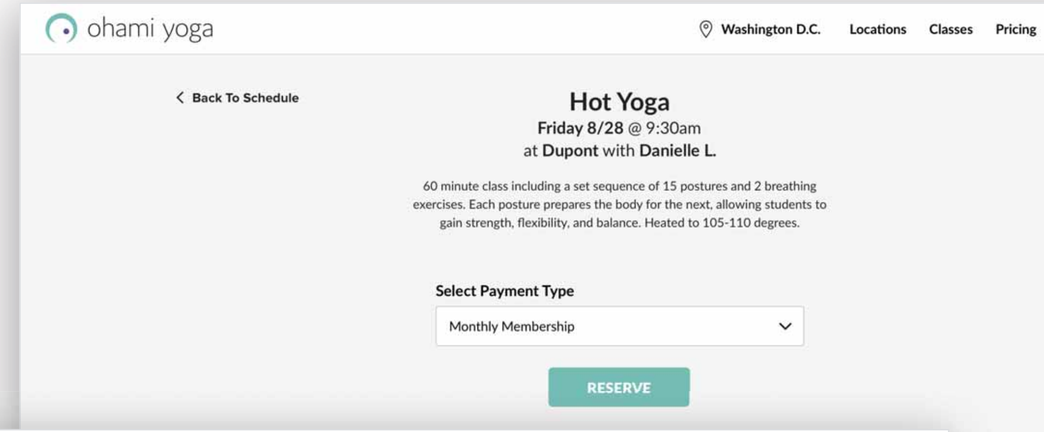
No design system, which meant many type styles and patterns, leading to a busy and confusing experience.

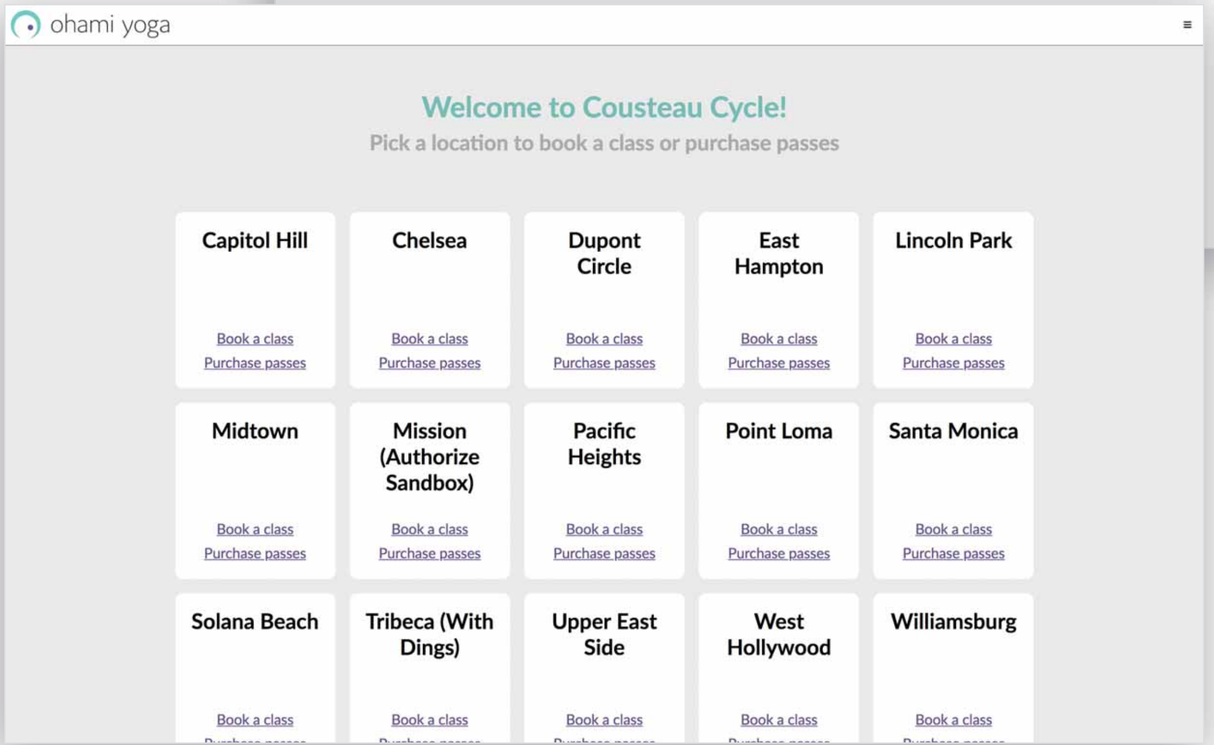
Lack of Staff

Because Mariana was a very young startup, many of us ended up wearing very different hats.

Lack of Brand

Design was a free-for-all when I joined. The only consistent branding aspect being the logo.





My Process Oriented Approach

Because the product and company was fairly new there were fewer product teams to coordinate across but that also meant more time and effort went into client comms. Here are the steps I initially took to set a good foundation for this initiative.

Establish a more complete brand

Research Failure Points

Collaboration Across Teams

Comms Strategy for Clients

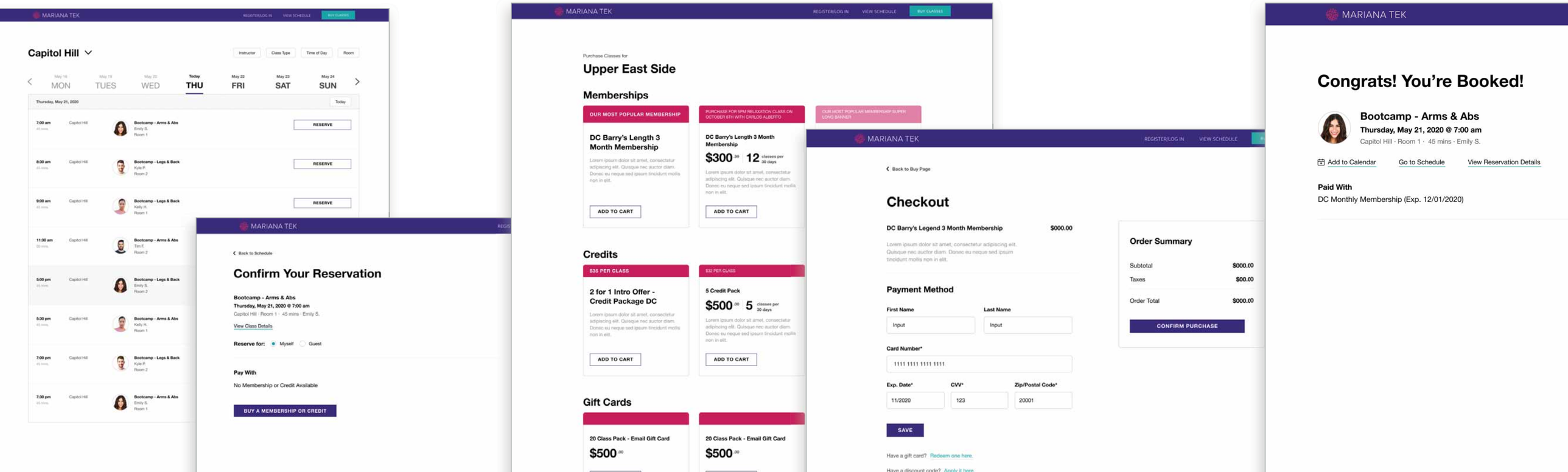
My Design / UX Approach

Using UX and Known Patterns

I used know log in, booking, and checkout patterns throughout to ensure our customers understood our system and were comfortable with it.

Design Flexibility

Because the design would need to work in our clients' webpages I kept the design simplistic, allowing clients to style the system on their end. I also worked with my engineering team to build the new system into an iFrame, for easy integration.



Portfolio Snippets

UX, Design & Research

Election Results

Washington Post via Development Seed

Project

Build an election application that would iframe into the Washington Post (web and mobile). Infographics were needed for: presidential, senate, house and gubernatorial races.

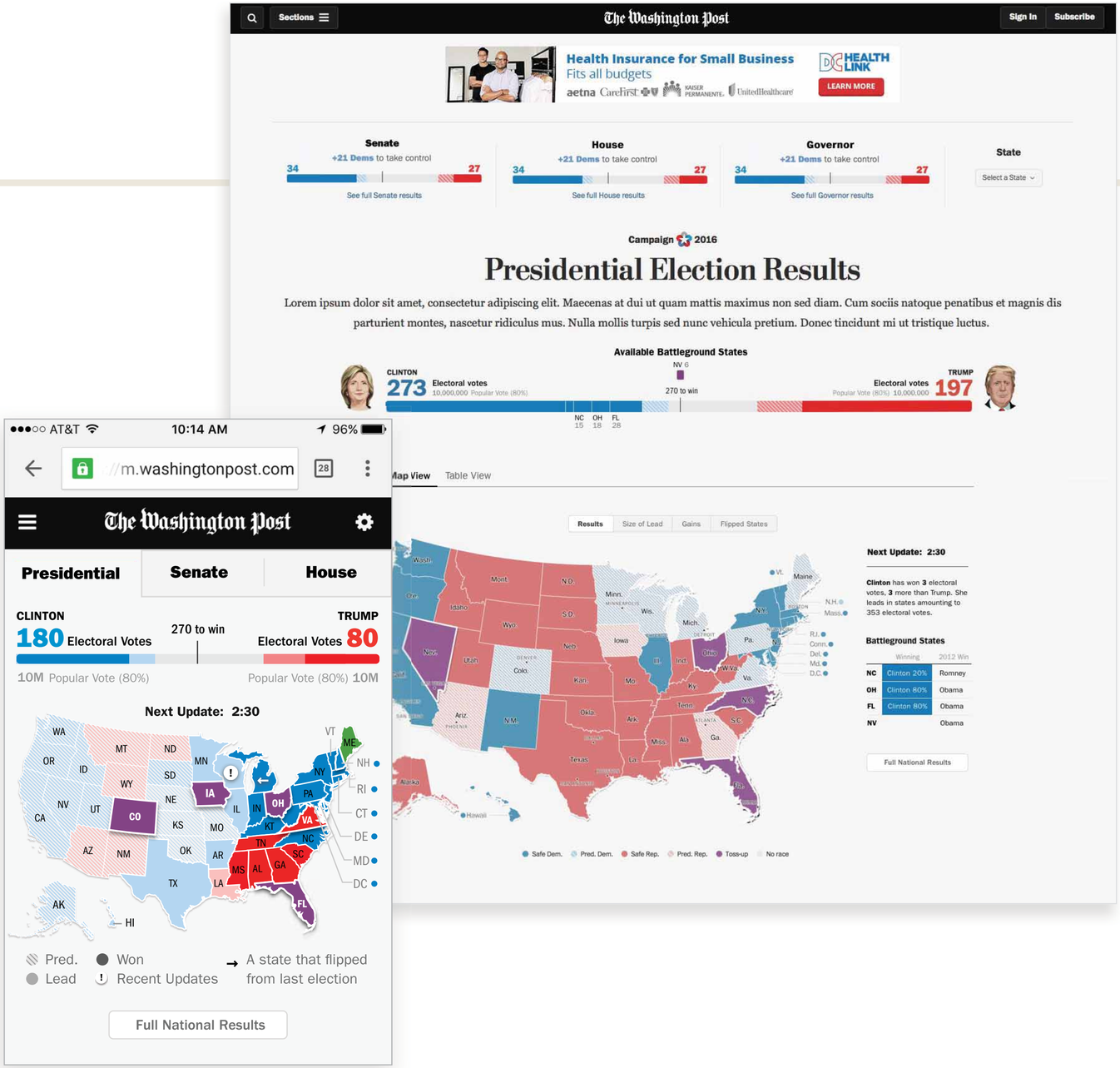
Outcome

The user friendly interface allowed users to:

- easily follow progress, on any device
- better understand updates happening throughout the night with visual cues
- see the overarching narrative but also allow users to dig in to the full, more in-depth one

My Deliverables / Role

Full UX and Design



Web Integrations

Mariana Tek

Project

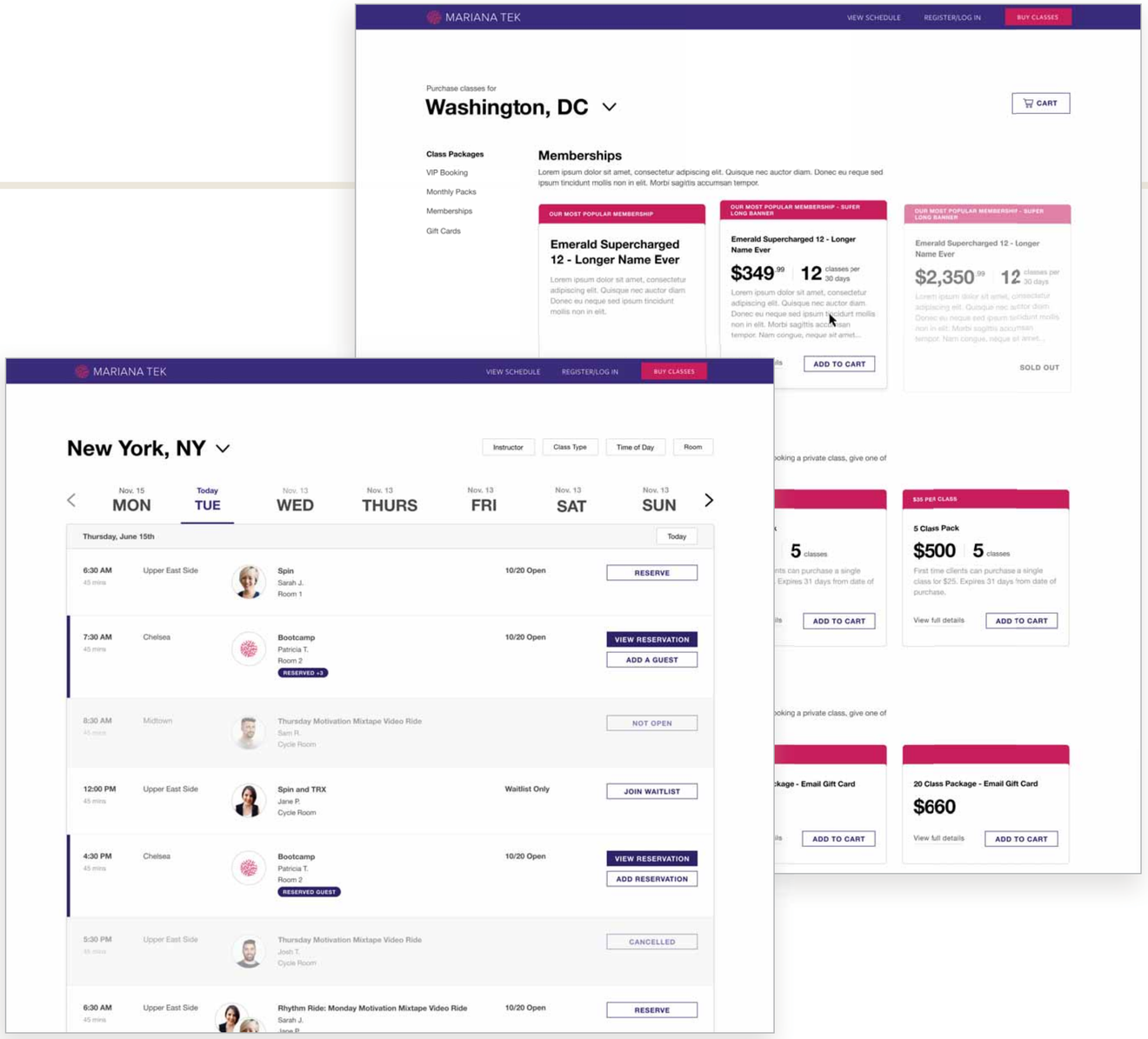
Mariana Tek offered fitness studios the ability to provide booking services and more. Taking the outdated and less functional version, we redesigned top to bottom into an iframe experience that would work across thousands of clients.

Outcome

The result - a 20x increase in new customers.
My design is still is what is being used in studios 5 years later.

My Deliverables / Role

- Full UX and Design
- Design and Development Oversight



Embedding Apps

Mariana Tek – Admin

Project

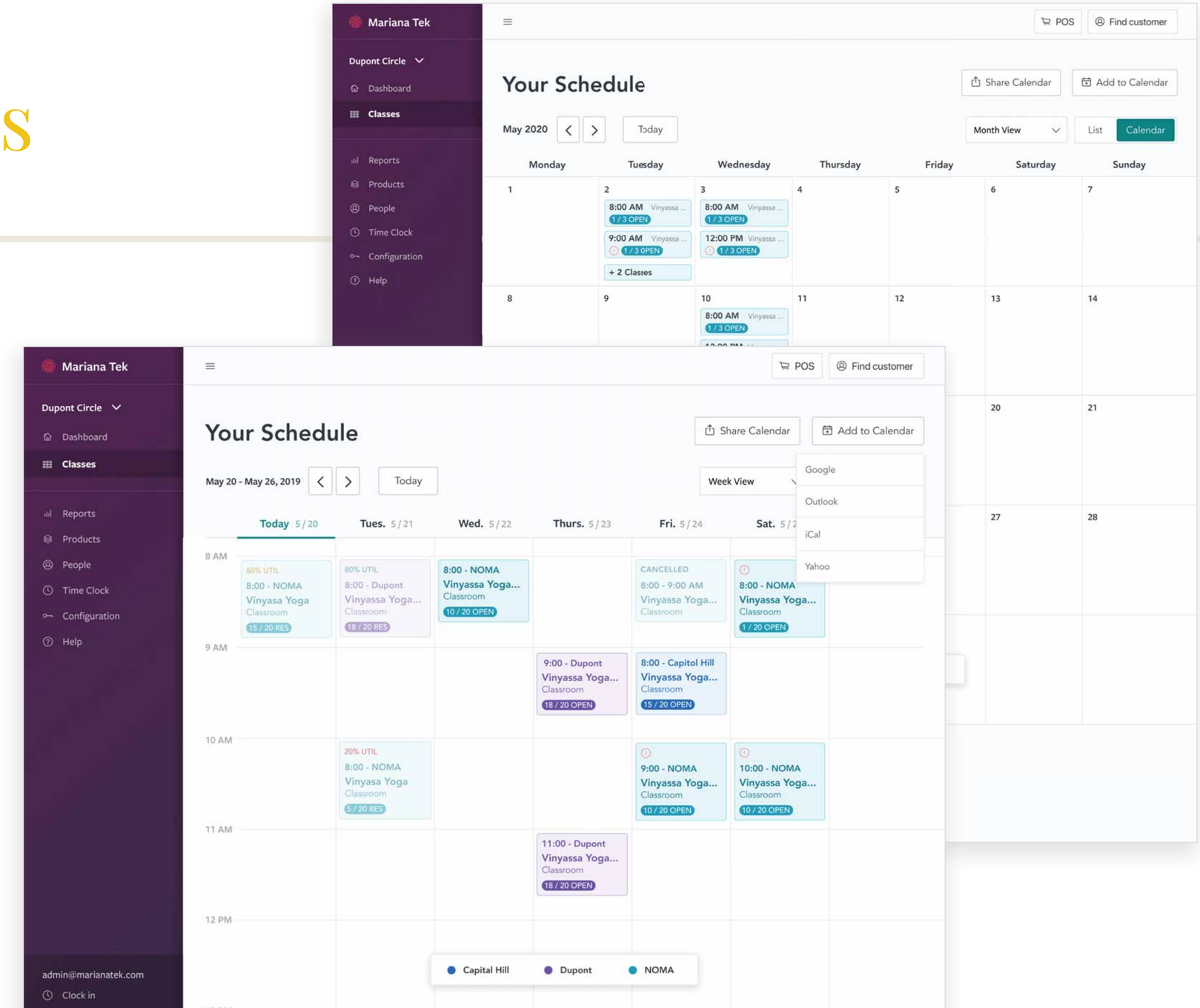
Build out systems to allow external developers to build onto the Mariana Tek platform, allowing for more flexibility and customization.

Outcome

Increased the number of large fitness contracts by 30%.

My Deliverables / Role

Full UX & Design



Admin

Mariana Tek

Project

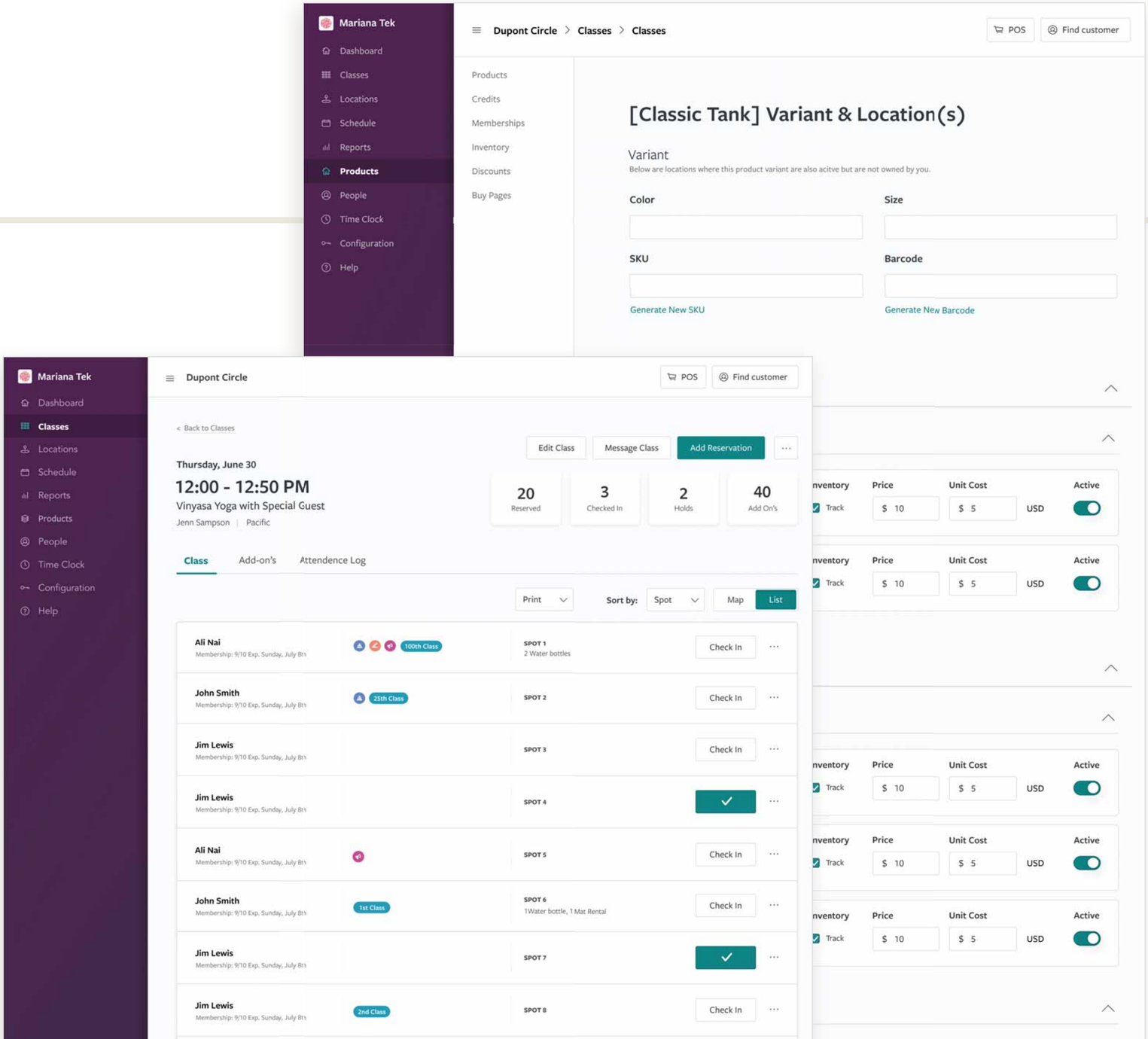
Redesign and rebuild parts of Mariana Tek's admin app - the oldest part of the system. This included a fitness class roster and inventory pages - some off the most used by our clients.

Outcome

This allowed for 20% fewer user errors and happier customers.

My Deliverables / Role

- Full UX & Design
- Design and Development Oversight



BILL/Divvy Merger

BILL

Project

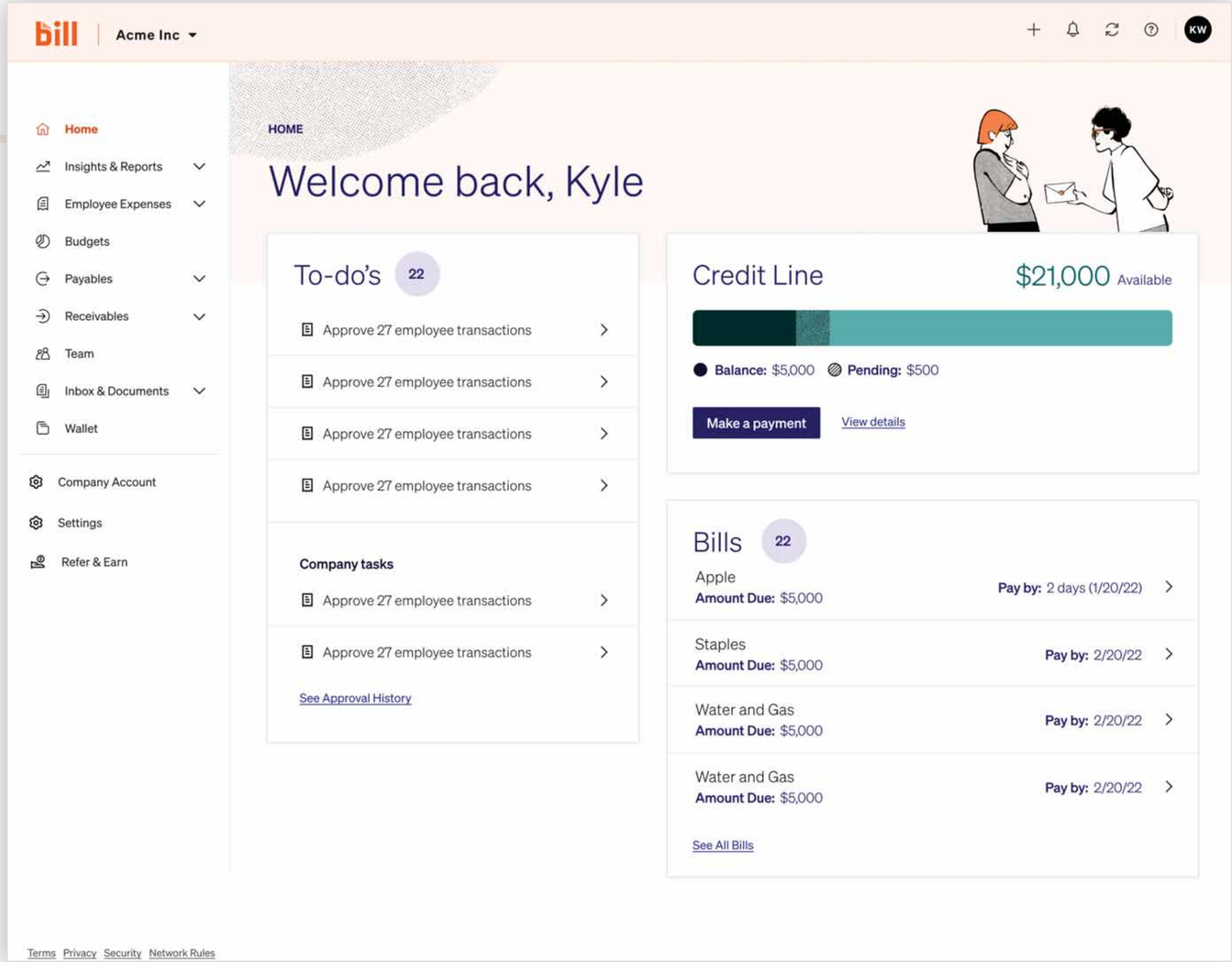
Merge BILL and Divvy products (functionality, code, etc...), as well as, redesign the merged product by bringing in the new brand built by the marketing team.

Outcome

Lead the design system team and Principal designers in research and rethinking the entire system, to get to the best user and business outcomes.

My Deliverables / Role

- Some Design
- Management / Oversight as Director



Service Year

NCOC via ISL

Project

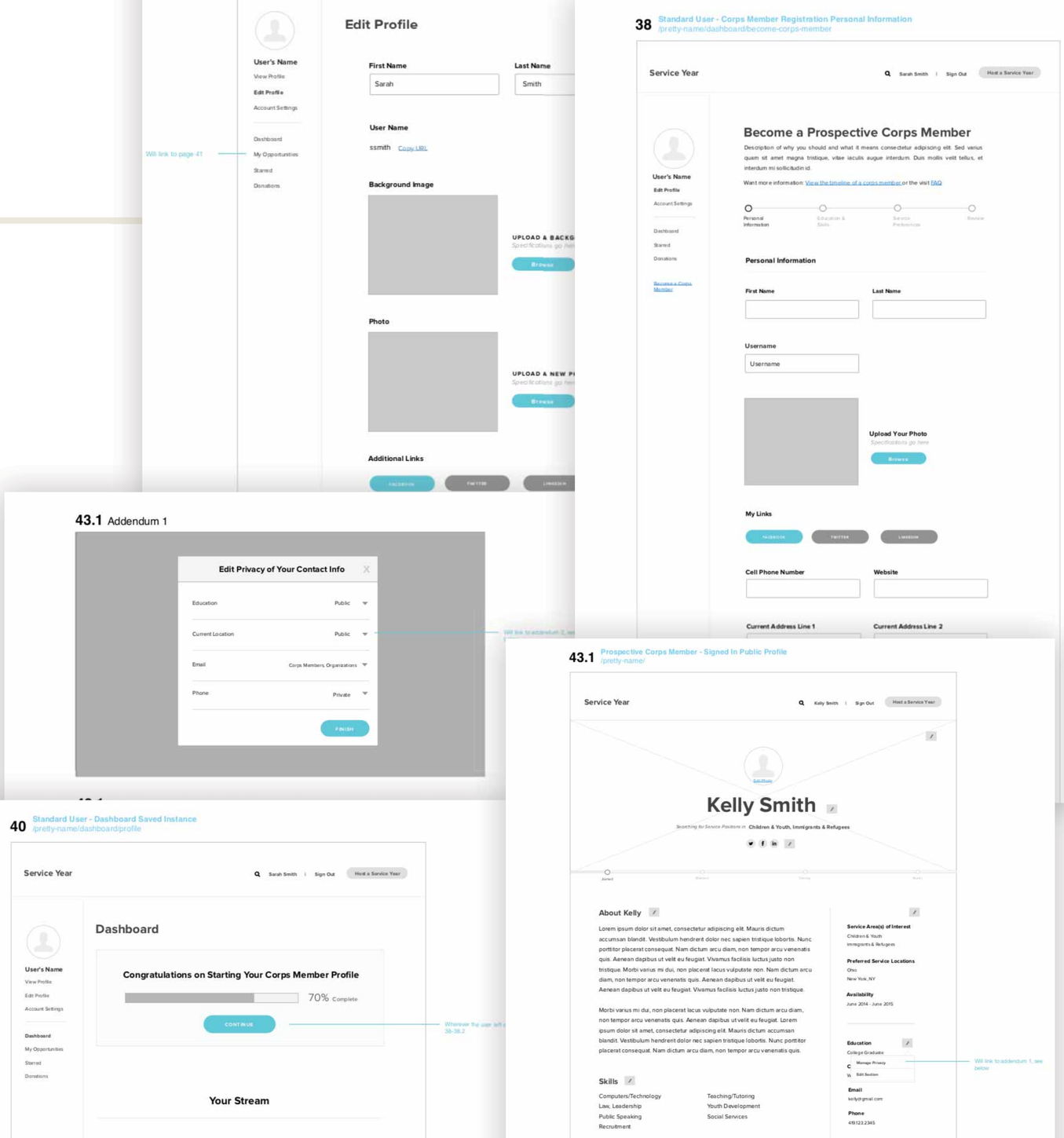
Match volunteers to a 1 year volunteer opportunity throughout the country. The project consisted of: a marketing website, and admin systems for our clients, organizations that needed volunteers, and volunteers to apply, track their progress etc…

Outcome

I translated a small but complex idea into a full product. The application has allowed approx 60,000 volunteers to go through the system each year.

My Deliverables / Role

- Stakeholder and Interviews
- UI Deliverables: Wireframes, sitemap etc…
- Led user testing with a team
- Oversaw design and development



Design System

Mariana Tek - Admin

Project

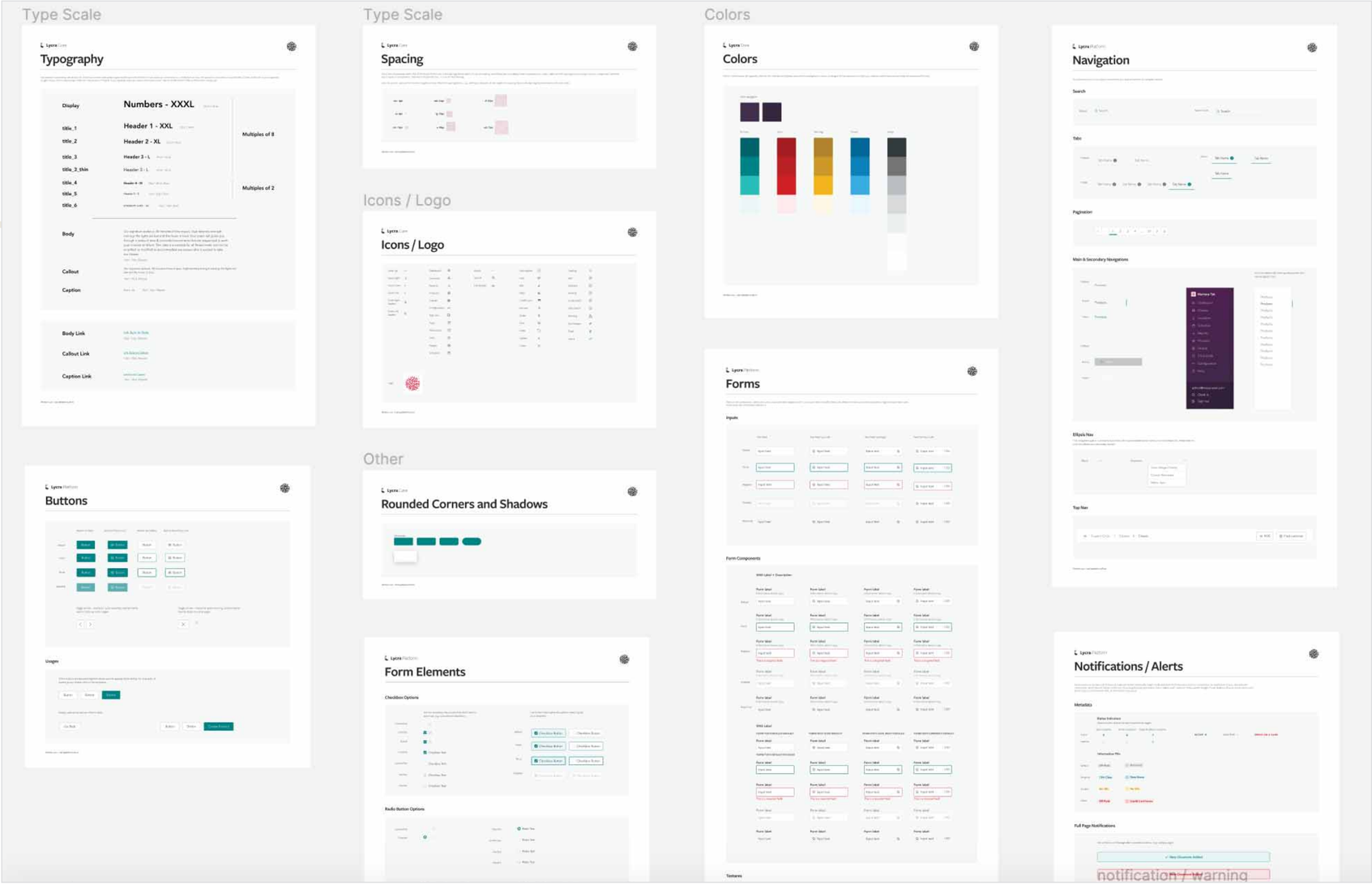
Creating a full design system - revising assets, creating ones as needed, and working with developers to complete them in code.

Outcome

Once complete, it allowed us to build product at 2x speed.

My Deliverables / Role

Full UI & Design



StockUp Personas

StockUp via ISL

Project

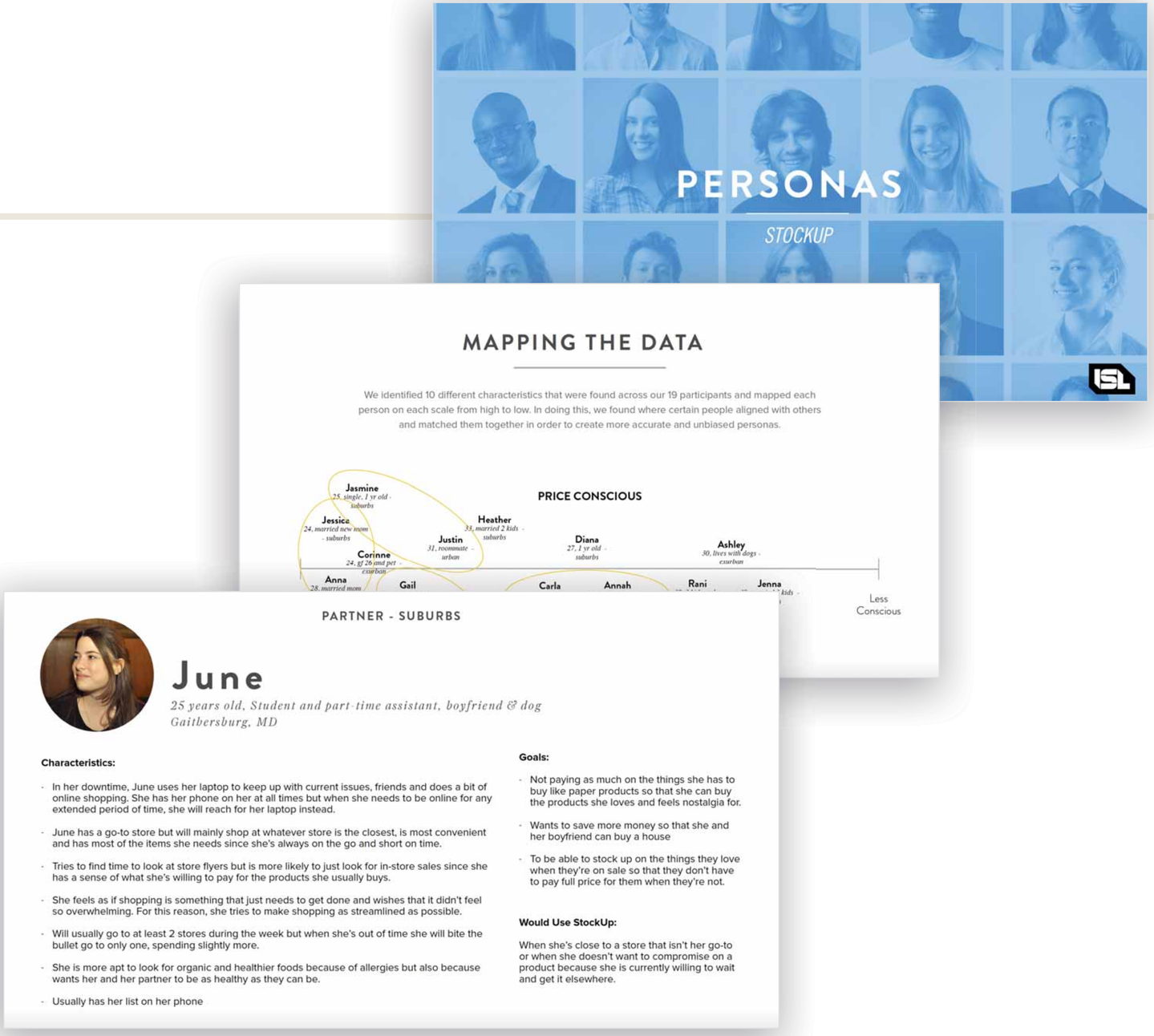
Figure out what kind of person was more likely to use StockUp's product so that they could better market to them.

Outcome

I delivered a full set of data-driven personas that allowed StockUp to specifically target who would use and love their application. This also debunked their initial idea of who they would market to.

My Deliverables / Role

- User Interviews
- Surveys
- Personas



Room 523

Octagon via ISL

Project

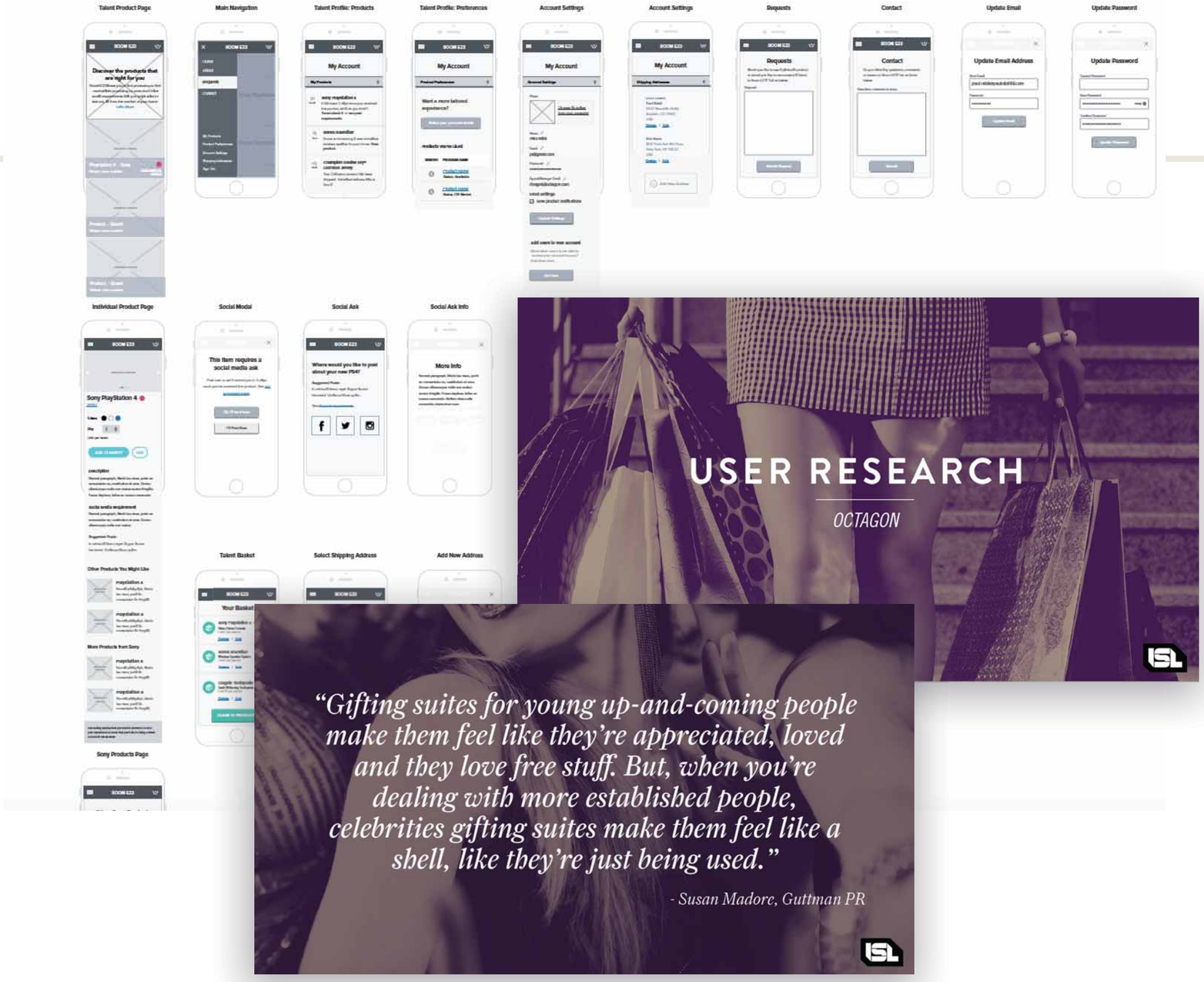
The talent agency, Octagon, wanted to better optimize giving away free gifts to their talent online.

Outcome

After researching, we delivered a mobile and web product, as well as a site for admin users.

My Deliverables / Role

- User and stakeholder Interviews
- UI Deliverables: Wireframes, sitemap etc..
- User Testing
- Oversaw design and development



Portfolio

Marketing Design

Mariana Tek Branding

Mariana Tek

Project

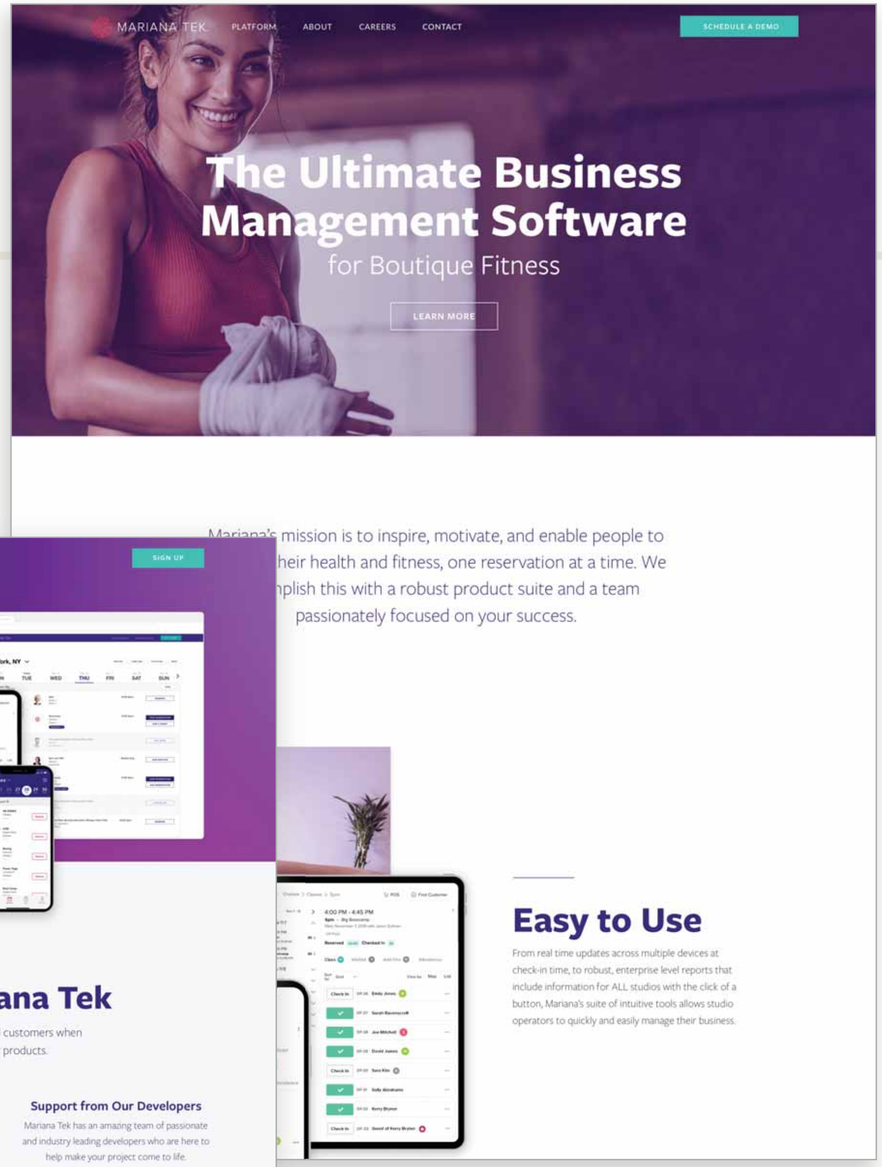
Build out the Mariana Tek brand (with the exception of the logo) and incorporate it through all marketing, promotional and product materials.

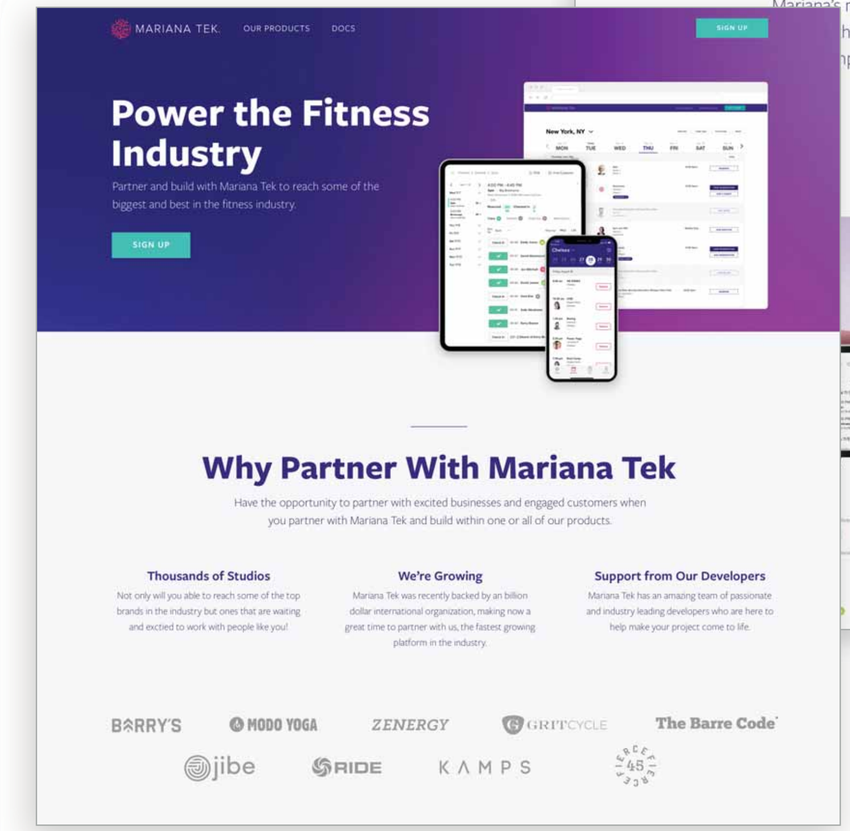
Outcome

The new design brought legitimacy to the company and built trust with clients, allowing Marina Tek to grow exponentially.

My Deliverables / Role

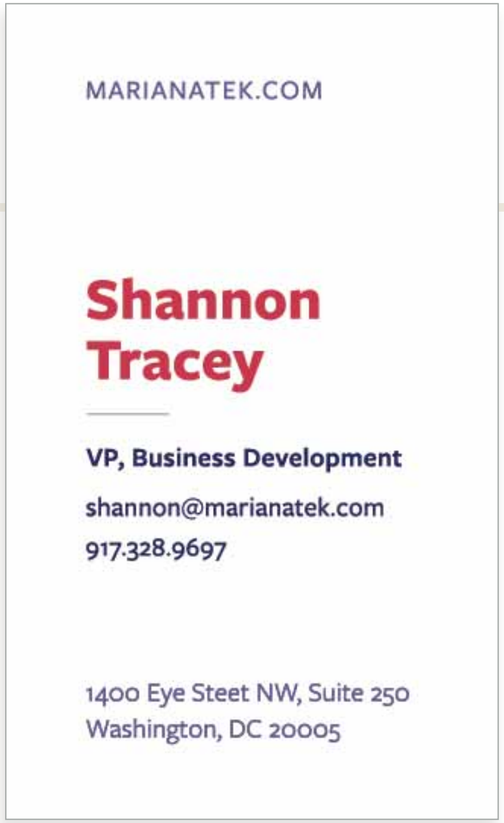
Full Design

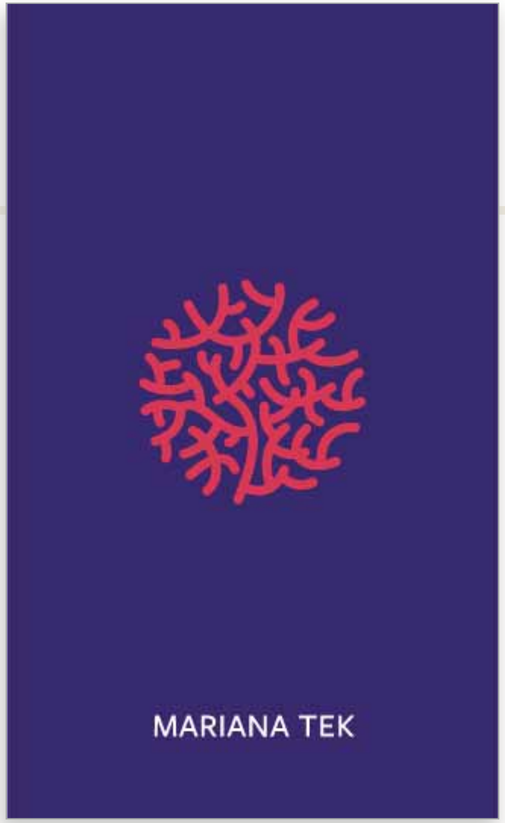




Business Cards

Mariana Tek





Mission & Values (posters and stickers)

Mariana Tek

Project

To make internal company values more visible and build on comrade.

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Look forward to hearing from you!

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